

The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

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waterfall is stained yellow and deposits of minerals and salts around the waterfall suggest that the water has been pouring from the holes for a while. The warm water and the mist surrounding the area limits vision, and the noise while not terribly loud is loud enough that hearing is difficult in the area. You are able to peek around the waterfall some and determine that the room beyond appears to be very wide and deep, but because of the blocking waterfall, you cannot be sure of the exact size. The room is dimly lit however by a faint white light that seems to emanate from the center of the room. The only thing that you can truly determine is that the roof is 25' high and made of smooth stone.

The water is terribly hot around 180° Fahrenheit and characters that brave the water by jumping through it are mildly scalded suffering 2d4 points of damage. Using shields or other items to block the fall of water reduces the damage to 1d4. Using magic to block the water removes the chance of damage. The mist around the area limits sight to about 10' and eliminates infravision, but once characters clear the waterfall's immediate area, infravision returns. The room is approximately 45' deep in this area but opens up to the north and south beyond the character's vision. Parts of this cavern are natural, while others are obviously shaped by tools. A large portion of this cavern bears stalactites and malactites some of which are quite large.

Relaxing on the other side of this room against a wall is a large band of Drow with slaves and "allies." With the Drow are nine trained hook horrors carrying heavy loads. In battle these hook horrors have to drop their load taking one round before they can enter the battle. They are returning from a scouting and looting mission. Because of the noise of the waterfall, they will not have heard the battle between the dead soldiers and the adventurers, but once the characters step through the waterfall; they will be plainly visible to these Drow with no cover to hide. The Drow, upon discovering the adventurers, will immediately cover themselves with *Globes of Darkness* and seek to hide within the cavern ordering the "allies" and hook horrors into battle. Not being fools, the Drow bide their time letting the slaves determine who among the characters are spell casters and clerics and then attack from the roof while *Levitating* behind *Globes of Darkness*. The Drow hiding among the stalactites on the roof are 25% concealed and the characters suffer a –2 penalty to their attack rolls against the Drow. Alternatively, if the DM desires, these are more renegade Drow although still faithful to Lloth, which might be willing to talk to the characters and may trade information with them for a price. These Drow are not friendly and while they have broken from their city and seek to establish a new city (to be the greatest place of worship to Lloth in the Realms), they will only talk with the characters if they have something worthwhile to trade. Information about the enclave of non-Lloth worshipping Drow would qualify as material information of worth or the DM can determine another source of information worthwhile to these Drow. Led by the female Drow cleric of Lloth, these Drow are seasoned fighters and experienced in warfare within the Under Dark. The cleric sees herself as a Drow version of Eve, desiring to be the mother of a whole city. The cleric may be a little insane, but what may seem as insane to others may be quite sane to Drow. It is also possible that the cleric is currently enjoying the favor of Lloth and may be under her influence.

Llothall'rosoth: Dark (drow) elf female C6 S 11, D 17, C 14, I 13, W 16, Ch 12; AL Chaotic Evil; AC 1; MV 12; hp 24; THAC0 18; XP 975.

Hobgoblin (20): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 5; MV 9; HD 1+1; hp 2x7, 3x6, 5x4, 4x9, 8, 2x3, 3x5; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35; wielding maces, spears, axes, and javelins.

Drow elf males F2 (11): S 11/0, D 7, C 6, I 8, W 17, Ch 10; AL CE; AC 4; MV 8; hp 9, 5, 18, 11, 7, 8, 6, 14, 4, 8, 2; THAC0 19; XP 35; wearing *Drow Chain Mail* +2, each carries a long dagger and short sword of adamantium alloy, but three bear hand crossbows with poisonous darts.

Muga Foe's Fiend: Hobgoblin male Sh5 S 15, D 14, C 14, I 14, W 17, Ch 9; AL Lawful Evil; AC 1; MV 4; hp 11; THAC0 18; XP 650.

Hobgoblin, Leader: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 3; MV 9; HD 1d1+8; hp 9; THAC0 17; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35; wearing *Chain Mail* +2, a medium shield and wielding a *Bastard Sword* +2.

Hobgoblin Sub-chief: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC -1; MV 9; HD 2; hp 11; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon +2 on damage; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 65; wielding a *Hand Axe of Quickness*, a medium shield and wearing *Banded Mail* +3.

Hook Horror (9): Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 3; MV 9; HD 5; hp 23, 2x22, 13, 24, 30, 31, 16, 19; THAC0 15; #AT 3; Dmg 1-8/1-8/2-12; SZ L; ML Steady (11-12); XP 175.

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Human, Slave (12): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL N; AC 10; MV 12; HD 1d6; hp 6, 3x2, 4x4, 1, 3x5; THAC0 20; #AT ; Dmg ; SZ M; ML Unreliable (2); XP 15.

The hook horrors are carefully raised and bred by these Drow, a specialty of their previous city, and use them for heavy shock troops. They are too stupid for anything else but fighting, and heavy lifting and are handled with great care since they have been known to turn on their handlers. The hobgoblins believe that they are the allies of the Drow, a misconception since the Drow view them as cannon fodder, and little better than the slaves are. If the characters battle the Drow and win, searching the cleric's *Bag of Holding* reveals several small packets of black cloth. Inside these packets is a fortune in uncut gem stones totaling 4,258 gp. Some of these gems are banded agate, obsidian, moonstone, black onyx, jade, jet, black opals, black sapphires, and several rich blue diamonds. These gems stolen from the Drow's previous city are mundane with the exception of the blue diamonds of a unique luster that other Drow from the same city or surrounding area would immediately recognize. The mine that produces these wondrous gems is found only within that city's realm of influence. Should the characters keep some of these diamonds and either use them as trade or display them in jewelry, they might have some uncomfortable encounters in the Under Dark when encountering other Drow. Also found within the bag is the cleric's prayer book, and two *Potions of Extra Healing*. Searching the hook horrors' loads reveals mundane underground traveling material enough to support a group of 15 Drow for a month. The exact materials are up to the DM, but may include fresh water, food, wine, spare clothing, and basic necessities.

Characters with enough magic and material can collect enough purified fresh water from the waterfall to support themselves. The characters will need enough material to collect the water letting it cool and then purify it using magic. The polluted water contains the same elements as the other water sources in this complex.

Room #23.

As the characters exit the previous room, they enter this long winding passageway and travel for nearly a mile before they enter this room. The worked passageway slowly descends deeper underground at a very slight angle and possibly, only a dwarven character would notice this.

[The passageway suddenly ends in a large natural cavern. The cavern is 15' wide and 25' long with a roof of varying heights but averages about 65' high.](#)

The characters travel about a mile after leaving this room before reaching the entrance to the next room.

Room #24.

[You come upon a huge, dark natural cavern. The cavern extends in every direction past the reach of any vision and light. The densely filled cavern contains several species of lichen, moss, and fungi, some of which are quite large. A large pool of shallow steaming yellow-stained water is not too far from the entrance \(near the center of the room\). This pool lies at the base of a large mound. Grouped around the mound eating the moss and fungi are many black and brown bison-like creatures. There are nine smaller creatures near them that are under the careful observation of the larger creatures and you assume these are young guarded by their parents. These creatures are alert and wary.](#)

Within the mound is the lair of a drider mage and his familiar a sinister bat that is flying within the cavern and has reported the presence of the adventurers unless they have taken steps to obscure their entrance. The drider is in possession of the teleportation mirror to the surface. He enjoys the power and status of owning this magical device and in his warped mind; this is a fitting position for him. With an appropriate bribe, the drider mage allows creatures to use this mirror and has made himself rich, powerful, feared and several enemies one of them Madame Nova, who has occasionally scryed this room to see if the characters managed to reach the mirror. Madame Nova hopes that the characters will slay the drider mage erasing a problem from her area without her risking any of her people.

The drider alerted to the approach of the characters by his familiar, will climb to the top of the mound and greet the characters first in under common and then surface common. He will attempt to assess their strengths and weaknesses by how they act and respond to his questions. The DM must be careful to portray the drider as cultured and well educated, with excellent manners while still being very dangerous. If asked he freely admits that he has the mirror and may even boast of it. Depending upon the DM and what the characters are willing to offer as a bribe for the use of the mirror, the drider allows the characters to use the mirror and leave the area disappointing Madame Nova but not enough to sour relations with the characters. Suitable bribes could be mage's spell books, gems of sufficient worth (particularly ones taken from other Drow) or all of the parties' gems. However, if a character possesses a *Wish* spell in either scroll or spell book, the drider will do anything to possess it and will gladly trade the use of the mirror for the spell. Depending upon how the characters interact with the drider, such as alluding that they have a *Wish* spell but offering something else instead or are unwilling to trade the spell, the drider may attack the characters anyway or just the one that possess the spell. Remember that the drider is unpredictable because of his chaotic and evil nature. A favorite tactic since the characters enter the mirror one at a time, is to let part of the party go and attack the remainder preferably once the fighters and clerics have left. He will not chase any characters into the mirror, and once through the mirror the characters are safe from the drider and out of the complex.

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Elf, Drider Mage: Int. High to Supra-Genius (14-20); AL CE; AC 3; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 28; THAC0 13; #AT 1; Dmg 1-4 (+ poison) or by weapon; SA Spells as 6th - 8th level mage; SZ L; ML Elite (14); XP 3,000; *Mace of Wreckage*²¹; *Sikken*²² (+2 dagger); *Necklace of Mystic Eidolons*.

Bat, Sinister (very intelligent): Int. 11-12 Very intelligent; AL LE; AC 3; MV 3, FI 18(C); HD 4+4; hp 24; THAC0 17; #AT 1; Dmg 2-5; SA Magic use (hold monster once a day); SD Energy field (stops missile attacks); SZ L; ML Champion (15-16); XP 2,000; *Ring of Protection* +2.

The rothe are not aggressive and will quickly evade the characters. However, if they attack the rothe form ranks around the young to protect them. The nine young are AC 6, have one HD and five hp.

Rothe (19):

Room #25, The drider's lair.

Entering the drider's lair through a gentle, downward-sloping tunnel with a 16'-high roof, you notice that it is brightly lit and warm. The tunnel is also trapped twice which the drider will disarm if the characters are entering the tunnel with him. Both traps contain six thin glass globes, which drop from the ceiling if the pressure plate is stepped upon with more than 25 pounds of force. Three of these glass globes are filled with ascomoid spores and the other three are flash globes. Locating both traps is not difficult but the cunning construction of the pressure plates causes the thief attempting to disarm the traps to suffer a -25% chance of success. Both traps drop their globes and effect an area 10' in diameter, and all creatures within the area of effect must save versus poison or die within 1d4 rounds from infection. Those who successfully save are blinded and choked to such an extent that they require 1d4 rounds to recover. Those who fail are also blinded and out of action (scratching furiously) for 6+1d4 rounds or until their eyes are flushed with fresh water for a full round. The luminous droplets cause an AC penalty of +2 even if the characters save versus poison. Those characters that fail are completely helpless; all attacks against them are at +4 bonus, with no shield or Dexterity bonuses allowed.

Entering the small chamber under the mound reveals it to have the pungent unique smell of a drider, and has been lived in for some time. The room is 45' deep and 25' wide and has a ceiling 18' high. Upon twin ledges on either side of the room stacked boxes, chests, and bags made of various materials. In the center of the eastern wall is a large, gilt-framed mirror covered in a thick black felt curtain.

Searching the room reveals 12 pp, 148 gp, 137 sp, 267 ep, 3,402 gp in various gems (both cut and uncut, but all unmounted), the drider's spell books and several scrolls. The spell books contains the spells that the drider has memorized plus the spells *Spidereyes*, *Spider Climb*, *Hold Portal*, and *Dark Wings*. Within the chests are old Drow clothes, possibly the drider's before he was changed. None of the clothing is of real value to the adventurers, but some of the cloth might fetch a fair price determined by the DM in the right market. Stashed within the clothes are a few scrolls of mundane house records that might be of interest to the right sage (the DM can include any adventure hooks and red herrings he desires here). Tucked within the records is a rare Drow spell *Protection from Earth and Stone*. Found within the mounds of bags is mundane adventuring gear, such as hooded lanterns, lamp oil, rotting lengths of hemp rope, and other such items of little or no use. However, if the characters carefully search the pile, for at least four rounds they uncover a pair of *Bracers of Defense* AC 2, a *Ring of Feather Falling* and a *Ring of Armoring*.

The mirror requires no words to activate it, is set to the same area, and cannot be shifted. The characters only need to step into the mirror, which will transport an unlimited number of items per day as long as they are ogre-sized or smaller. The mirror is not permanently mounted and can be removed, however, there is no way to utilize the mirror's power and take it with you.

Summary.

The DM is encouraged to remember that Drow items disintegrate in normal sunlight and when the adventurers return to the surface, most of the magical items retrieved from fallen Drow are going to be rendered useless in a short time. Any item exposed to the light of the sun for more than two rounds in at a time any exposure totaling more than five rounds in any five-day period irreversible decay begins. Within 2d6 days, the items lose their magical properties and crumble to worthless dust. Items protected from direct sunlight still lose their magical properties within 1d20+30 days. The DM should make note of what Drow items the adventures carry, especially the Drow cleric's *Bag of Holding* since when the bag is destroyed, all items within are lost.

The renegade Drow can become an unusual source of information and commerce in the Underdark region and can become a central focal point for the DM to use as adventure hooks for later forays into the Underdark. The complex may be linked with other such adventures as the U series, and any other adventure set within the Underdark.

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¹ Alternate spelling Goibhniu, and known in Wales as Gofannon, both derived from the word for smith. Part of the triad of craftsman-gods, the others being Luchta (or Luchtain) the wright and Creidhne the worker in metal; Celtic Mythology page 34 by Proinsias Mac Cana, new revised edition ©1985.

² Deities and Demigods page #28. In my campaign, this deity is a minor power with a very small amount of worshippers mostly found in the North among barbarians and sea folk.

³ Named after Bartlesville, OK in honor of my grandfather who lived there for a while.

⁴ Drow of the Underdark pages 42-44.

⁵ Symbols of the Celts by Sabine Heinz ©1999. Celtic legend refers to ducks that retrieve magical items from bodies of water.

⁶ Symbols of the Celts by Sabine Heinz ©1999.

⁷ Dictionary of Celtic Myth and Legend page 106 by Miranda J. Green ©1992 and The Encyclopedia of Religion Volume #3 page 155 by Mircea Eliade.

⁸ This is a symbol of his office, as well as a magical item, and oaths and promises made while holding a torque are considered binding and no member of this church or the two brethren churches would dare break a promise made upon a torque lest bad luck befall him; Symbols of the Celts page 179 by Sabine Heinz ©1999.

⁹ In my campaign, several orc tribes are advanced enough to maintain horses, and there are large tribes of scro taken from the Spelljammer setting.

¹⁰ I, Tyrant page 11 and 75.

¹¹ Dragon Magazine #147 “Magic for Beginners” by Gregory W. Detwiler.

¹² Unearthed Arcana page 52.

¹³ Dungeon Master’s Guide Table #51 page 73.

¹⁴ Dragon Magazine #179 “Unique Magical Candles for Your Campaign” by Gregg Chamberlain.

¹⁵ Gods, Goddesses, and Monsters page 76-77 ©2000 by Sheila Keenan. Janus was the Roman god of beginning and all gates, and doors where under his protection. The origins of Janus may be from the Gauls, contemporaries of the Celts and the Romans might have adopted his worship from conquering these people. His gate on the Northeast side of the Roman Forum was closed in peace and opened in wartime. Another minor deity in my campaign, who fulfills the same role as he did for the Romans, and is allied with Mystra, and Azuth, because magical gates fall within his portfolio.

¹⁶ Unearthed Arcana page 37.

¹⁷ The Drow of the Underdark page 99.

¹⁸ Dungeon Master’s Guide page 168.

¹⁹ Drow of the Underdark, page, god of

²⁰ Deity from

²¹ Lore of the Crypt, Book #1 Magical Treasures, Underworld Publishing page ?

²² Lore of the Crypt, Book #1 Magical Treasures, Underworld Publishing page ?